TEMPLE ARCHITECTURE AND CHANDELLA-KHAJURAHO

CENTRAL THESIS → CORE VOCABULARY → CHRONOLOGY RAIL → NAGARA FAMILY → PALLAVA TO CHOLA → DECCAN CAUTION

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

◆ PRIMARY CORE FLOW ● SUBORDINATE EXTRA ◆ APPROVAL / REVIEW

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

00

STAGE 00

CENTRAL THESIS

CENTRAL THESIS | TEMPLE ARCHITECTURE IS BEST READ AS AN EVOLVING REGIONAL | POWER, MATERIAL, SCULPTURE AND INSTITUTIONAL LIFE - NOT AS | TEMPLE ARCHITECTURE IS BEST

Temple architecture is best read as an evolving regional argument about sacred space

power, material, sculpture and institutional life - not as a monument list.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- Temple architecture is best read as an evolving regional argument about sacred space.
- power, material, sculpture and institutional life - not as a monument list.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Temple architecture is best read as an evolving regional argument about sacred space.
- power, material, sculpture and institutional life - not as a monument list.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Temple architecture is best read as an evolving regional argument about sacred space.
- power, material, sculpture and institutional life - not as a monument list.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Temple architecture is best read as an evolving regional argument about sacred space, power, material, sculpture and institutional life - not as a monument list.

01

STAGE 01

CORE VOCABULARY

CORE VOCABULARY | VERTICAL TERMS | DRAVIDA PATH | JAGATI → ARDHAMANDAPA → MANDAPA → ANTARALA → GARBHAGRIHA.

jagati → ardhamandapa → mandapa → antarala → garbhagriha.

vertical terms → jangha / shikhara / urushringa / amalaka / kalasha. → Dravida path → vimana / gopura / prakara / corridor / tank.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- jagati → ardhamandapa → mandapa → antarala → garbhagriha.
- vertical terms → jangha / shikhara / urushringa / amalaka / kalasha.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Dravida path → vimana / gopura / prakara / corridor / tank.
- jagati → ardhamandapa → mandapa → antarala → garbhagriha.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- vertical terms → jangha / shikhara / urushringa / amalaka / kalasha.
- Dravida path → vimana / gopura / prakara / corridor / tank.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Dravida path → vimana / gopura / prakara / corridor / tank.

02

STAGE 02

CHRONOLOGY RAIL

CHRONOLOGY RAIL | GUPTA STRUCTURAL BEGINNINGS | MATURE NAGARA AND EARLY DRAVIDA | PALLAVA TURN | CHOLA IMPERIAL SCALE | DECCAN EXPERIMENTS | VIJAYANAGARA AND NAYAKA. | KEEP ANCIENT DEVELOPMENT SEPARATE FROM MODERN RECOVERY AND UNESCO

Gupta structural beginnings → mature Nagara and early Dravida → Pallava turn → Chola imperial scale → Deccan experiments → Vijayanagara and Nayaka. → Keep ancient development separate from modern recovery and UNESCO years.

CHRONOLOGY / PHASE

- Gupta structural beginnings → mature Nagara and early Dravida → Pallava turn
- Chola imperial scale → Deccan experiments → Vijayanagara and Nayaka.

MATERIAL / INSTITUTION

- Keep ancient development separate from modern recovery and UNESCO years.
- Gupta structural beginnings → mature Nagara and early Dravida → Pallava turn

IMPACT / LIMIT

- Chola imperial scale → Deccan experiments → Vijayanagara and Nayaka.
- Keep ancient development separate from modern recovery and UNESCO years.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Keep ancient development separate from modern recovery and UNESCO years.

03

STAGE 03

NAGARA FAMILY

NAGARA FAMILY | REKHA DEUL SANCTUM + PIDHA DEUL HALL + ENCLOSURE-CONSCIOUS | HIGH JAGATI + NO ENCLOSURE WALL + CLUSTERED SHIKHARA | MODHERA + SURYA KUND + DISTINCT WESTERN NAGARA SOLUTION.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY	EVIDENCE / MECHANISM	DEBATE / LEGACY
ODISHA → rekha deul sanctum + pidha deul hall + enclosure-conscious Kalinga form.	SOLANKI → Modhera + Surya Kund + distinct western Nagara solution.	KHAJURAHO → high jagati + no enclosure wall + clustered shikhara + dense sculpture.
KHAJURAHO → high jagati + no enclosure wall + clustered shikhara + dense sculpture.	ODISHA → rekha deul sanctum + pidha deul hall + enclosure-conscious Kalinga form.	SOLANKI → Modhera + Surya Kund + distinct western Nagara solution.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- ODISHA → rekha deul sanctum + pidha deul hall + enclosure-conscious Kalinga form.
- KHAJURAHO → high jagati + no enclosure wall + clustered shikhara + dense sculpture.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- SOLANKI → Modhera + Surya Kund + distinct western Nagara solution.
- ODISHA → rekha deul sanctum + pidha deul hall + enclosure-conscious Kalinga form.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- KHAJURAHO → high jagati + no enclosure wall + clustered shikhara + dense sculpture.
- SOLANKI → Modhera + Surya Kund + distinct western Nagara solution.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: SOLANKI → Modhera + Surya Kund + distinct western Nagara solution.

04

STAGE 04

PALLAVA TO CHOLA

PALLAVA TO CHOLA | ROCK-CUT CAVE | MONOLITHIC RATHA | STRUCTURAL TEMPLE. | EARLY SHRINES | BRIHADISHVARA CLIMAX | LATER GOPURA EMPHASIS. | WRITE ARCHITECTURE WITH BRONZES, MURALS AND INSCRIPTIONS TOGETHER.

Pallava → rock-cut cave → monolithic ratha → structural temple.

Chola → early shrines → Brihadishvara climax → later gopura emphasis. → Rule → write architecture with bronzes, murals and inscriptions together.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- Pallava → rock-cut cave → monolithic ratha → structural temple.
- Chola → early shrines → Brihadishvara climax → later gopura emphasis.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Rule → write architecture with bronzes, murals and inscriptions together.
- Pallava → rock-cut cave → monolithic ratha → structural temple.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Chola → early shrines → Brihadishvara climax → later gopura emphasis.
- Rule → write architecture with bronzes, murals and inscriptions together.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Rule → write architecture with bronzes, murals and inscriptions together.

05

STAGE 05

DECCAN CAUTION

DECCAN CAUTION | NAGARA AND DRAVIDA EVIDENCE ON ONE SITE. | USEFUL LABEL ONLY AFTER MORPHOLOGY IS DESCRIBED. | AIHOLE = INCUBATOR.

Aihole = incubator.

Badami = refinement. → Pattadakal = Nagara and Dravida evidence on one site. → Vesara = useful label only after morphology is described.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- Aihole = incubator.
- Badami = refinement.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Pattadakal = Nagara and Dravida evidence on one site.
- Vesara = useful label only after morphology is described.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Aihole = incubator.
- Badami = refinement.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Vesara = useful label only after morphology is described.

06

STAGE 06

HOYSALA AND KAKATIYA

HOYSALA AND KAKATIYA | SOAPSTONE + STELLATE JAGATI + ZIG-ZAG WALLS + LATHE-TURNED | THOUSAND PILLAR AND RAMAPPA | SANDBOX TECHNIQUE + NAMED ARCHITECT. | BOTH PROVE THAT MATERIAL AND ENGINEERING MATTER, NOT STYLE

HOYSALA → soapstone + stellate jagati + zig-zag walls + lathe-turned pillars.

KAKATIYA → Thousand Pillar and Ramappa → sandbox technique + named architect. → Both prove that material and engineering matter, not style labels alone.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- HOYSALA → soapstone + stellate jagati + zig-zag walls + lathe-turned pillars.
- KAKATIYA → Thousand Pillar and Ramappa → sandbox technique + named architect.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Both prove that material and engineering matter, not style labels alone.
- HOYSALA → soapstone + stellate jagati + zig-zag walls + lathe-turned pillars.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- KAKATIYA → Thousand Pillar and Ramappa → sandbox technique + named architect.
- Both prove that material and engineering matter, not style labels alone.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Both prove that material and engineering matter, not style labels alone.

07

STAGE 07

VIJAYANAGARA AND NAYAKA

VIJAYANAGARA AND NAYAKA | CHARIOT STREETS + MANDAPAS + RAYA GOPURAM + SACRED-ROYAL | CONCENTRIC ENCLOSURES + GRADED GOPURAS + TANKS + PRAKARAMS | VISUAL EMPHASIS SHIFTS FROM VIMANA TO GATEWAY AND CORRIDOR

Vijayanagara → chariot streets + mandapas + Raya gopuram + sacred-royal city.

Nayaka → concentric enclosures + graded gopuras + tanks + prakarams + stucco. → Mechanism → visual emphasis shifts from vimana to gateway and corridor system.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- Vijayanagara → chariot streets + mandapas + Raya gopuram + sacred-royal city.
- Nayaka → concentric enclosures + graded gopuras + tanks + prakarams + stucco.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Mechanism → visual emphasis shifts from vimana to gateway and corridor system.
- Vijayanagara → chariot streets + mandapas + Raya gopuram + sacred-royal city.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Nayaka → concentric enclosures + graded gopuras + tanks + prakarams + stucco.
- Mechanism → visual emphasis shifts from vimana to gateway and corridor system.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Mechanism → visual emphasis shifts from vimana to gateway and corridor system.

08

STAGE 08

TEMPLE AS INSTITUTION

TEMPLE AS INSTITUTION | RITUAL + PATRONAGE + ENDOWMENT + FESTIVAL + ADMINISTRATION | USE INSCRIPTIONS, MERCHANT-GUILD TRACES AND NAMED ARTISANS. | DO NOT TREAT TEMPLE EVIDENCE AS A FULL SOCIAL

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- ritual + patronage + endowment + festival + administration + craft labour.
- Use inscriptions, merchant-guild traces and named artisans.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Do not treat temple evidence as a full social census.
- ritual + patronage + endowment + festival + administration + craft labour.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Use inscriptions, merchant-guild traces and named artisans.
- Do not treat temple evidence as a full social census.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Do not treat temple evidence as a full social census.

09

STAGE 09

CHANDELLA AND KHAJURAHO DOSSIER

CHANDELLA AND KHAJURAHO DOSSIER | CHANDELLA ASSERTION | KHAJURAHO CLUSTERS. | MOST TEMPLES SANDSTONE; CHAUSATH YOGINI, BRAHMA AND MAHADEVA ARE | KHAJURAHO CHAUSATH YOGINI MUST BE KEPT SEPARATE FROM THE | KANDARIYA MAHADEVA | CULMINATION OF TOWER, WALL AND SCULPTURE INTEGRATION.

Jejabhukti / Bundelkhand → Chandella assertion → Khajuraho clusters.

Most temples sandstone; Chausath Yogini, Brahma and Mahadeva are granite exceptions. → Khajuraho Chausath Yogini must be kept separate from the circular Morena example. → Kandariya Mahadeva = culmination of tower, wall and sculpture integration.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- Jejabhukti / Bundelkhand → Chandella assertion → Khajuraho clusters.
- Most temples sandstone; Chausath Yogini, Brahma and Mahadeva are granite exceptions.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Khajuraho Chausath Yogini must be kept separate from the circular Morena example.
- Kandariya Mahadeva = culmination of tower, wall and sculpture integration.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- Jejabhukti / Bundelkhand → Chandella assertion → Khajuraho clusters.
- Most temples sandstone; Chausath Yogini, Brahma and Mahadeva are granite exceptions.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Kandariya Mahadeva = culmination of tower, wall and sculpture integration.

10

STAGE 10

KHAJURAHO IMAGERY CAUTION

KHAJURAHO IMAGERY CAUTION | BREADTH OF LIFE | DEITIES, WORSHIPPERS, TEACHERS, DANCERS, MUSICIANS, COURTLY LIFE. | EROTIC IMAGERY | REAL BUT ONLY ONE REGISTER AMONG MANY. | DO NOT REDUCE THE SITE TO SEXUALITY OR INVENT

breadth of life → deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly life.

erotic imagery → real but only one register among many. → Do not reduce the site to sexuality or invent unsupported percentages.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- breadth of life → deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly life.
- erotic imagery → real but only one register among many.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- Do not reduce the site to sexuality or invent unsupported percentages.
- breadth of life → deities, worshippers, teachers, dancers, musicians, courtly life.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- erotic imagery → real but only one register among many.
- Do not reduce the site to sexuality or invent unsupported percentages.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Do not reduce the site to sexuality or invent unsupported percentages.

11

STAGE 11

PYQ ROUTE AND CLOSE

PYQ ROUTE AND CLOSE | SCULPTURE AS SELECTED SOCIAL EVIDENCE. | PALLAVA CONTRIBUTION; CHOLA ACHIEVEMENT. | VIGOR + BREADTH OF LIFE AT KHAJURAHO. | 2021 AND 2026 PRELIMS | CONCEPT ANALYSED, ANSWER WITHHELD PENDING OFFICIAL KEY.

2022 → sculpture as selected social evidence. → 2024 → Pallava contribution; Chola achievement. → 2025 → vigor + breadth of life at Khajuraho. → 2021 and 2026 prelims → concept analysed, answer withheld pending official key.

POLITY / ECONOMY / SOCIETY

- 2022 → sculpture as selected social evidence.
- 2024 → Pallava contribution; Chola achievement.

EVIDENCE / MECHANISM

- 2025 → vigor + breadth of life at Khajuraho.
- 2021 and 2026 prelims → concept analysed, answer withheld pending official key.

DEBATE / LEGACY

- 2022 → sculpture as selected social evidence.
- 2024 → Pallava contribution; Chola achievement.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: 2021 and 2026 prelims → concept analysed, answer withheld pending official key.

E

EXTRA

SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT | 1. CLASSIFICATION CAUTION | 2. KHAJURAHO INTERPRETIVE CAUTION | 3. SOCIAL-HISTORY CAUTION | 4. CONSERVATION CAUTION | NAGARA, DRAVIDA AND VESARA ARE ANALYTICAL TOOLS, NOT CIVILISATIONAL | THE DECCAN ESPECIALLY REQUIRES MORPHOLOGY BEFORE LABEL | PATTADAKAL, HOYSALA AND KAKATIYA EVIDENCE RESISTS NEAT BOXING.

OPTIONAL SOURCE DEPTH

- 1. CLASSIFICATION CAUTION
- 2. KHAJURAHO INTERPRETIVE CAUTION
- 3. SOCIAL-HISTORY CAUTION
- 4. CONSERVATION CAUTION

ADVANCED DEBATE

- Nagara, Dravida and Vesara are analytical tools, not civilisational cages. Use them after describing plan, tower, material and enclosure logic.
- The Deccan especially requires morphology before label: Pattadakal, Hoysala and Kakatiya evidence resists neat boxing.
- Erotic imagery at Khajuraho has invited Tantric, symbolic, didactic and worldly-life interpretations.
- The source-safe line is that multiple interpretations exist and no single

LEGACY / NUANCE

- explanation should be presented as conclusively proven from the sculptures alone.
- Temple sculpture is selected representation shaped by patrons, artisans and sectarian goals.
- It is excellent for showing valued registers of life, but weak for measuring ordinary social frequency, demographic spread or non-elite experience.
- UNESCO's Khajuraho brief works at the level of the inscribed property and its clusters.

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.

END OF MASTER CANVAS • poster embeds this exact master • tiled pages are overlapping crops of the same pixels